

CHENAB BRIDGE

The massive steel edifice being constructed across the Chenab River Gorge, Jammu, at 1,315 m and spread over 17 piers may not be the longest in the country. Yet once it is built, the innocuously named Bridge No. 44 will be the most crucial component in the Katra–Banihal section of the Udhampur–Srinagar–Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL). It will also hold the distinction of being the highest steel arch railway bridge in the world. The centre of the arch rises 359 m above the river bed level, which is 35 m taller than the Eiffel Tower in Paris and almost five times the height of the Qutb Minar in Delhi. The span of the arch is 465 m.